GRADE 1 · UNPLUGGED SEQUENCING

Match the Algorithm

Read the steps and name the job

Name: .... Date: ....

★ **I can match an algorithm to the job its steps do.**

An algorithm does a job

Every algorithm does a job. Read the steps and figure out the job. Match each algorithm to its job. One job has no algorithm — you will write it.

The jobs

wash hands

feed the dog

get a drink

Algorithm 1

1. wet your hands
2. add soap
3. rinse
4. dry your hands

1 What job is Algorithm 1?

Read the steps. Which job does Algorithm 1 do? Write the job.

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Algorithm 2

1. get the bowl
2. scoop the food
3. put it down
4. call the dog

2 What job is Algorithm 2?

Which job does Algorithm 2 do? Write the job.

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3 You try — write the leftover one

The leftover job is 'get a drink'. Write an algorithm for it — 3 or 4 steps in order, one per line.

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Big idea

The steps of an algorithm tell you what job it does. Reading code to figure out what it does is a big part of being a coder.

TEACHER GUIDE · GRADE 1 · UNPLUGGED SEQUENCING

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Quick facilitation notes & answer key

What this worksheet teaches

Students read two sets of steps, work out which job each one does, then write the steps for a leftover job. Reading a plan to figure out what it accomplishes is a key thinking skill. No coding experience needed.

Before you start (no computer needed)

No computer — paper and a pencil. You read each prompt aloud. Optional: cut the steps into cards so students can physically slide them into order before writing.

How to lead it (about 20 minutes)

1. Show them (you do). Read a set of steps and ask: "what job is this?"
2. Do one together. Algorithm 1 is washing hands; Algorithm 2 is feeding the dog.
3. Let them try. Students write the steps for the leftover job (getting a drink).

Answer key (these are the verified correct answers)

Exercise 1 — Algorithm 1 = wash hands (wet, soap, rinse, dry). Exercise 2 — Algorithm 2 = feed the dog (get the bowl, scoop the food, put it down, call the dog).

Exercise 3 — get a drink: a sample is get a cup, turn on the tap, fill the cup, turn off the tap. Accept any 3–4 sensible ordered steps.

If students get stuck — and ways to adjust

Watch for: guessing the job from one step. Read all the steps before deciding.

Make it easier: give two job names to choose between.

Make it harder: ask them to add a step that would make the job clearer.

Ontario curriculum link (official wording)

C3.1 — solve problems and create computational representations of mathematical situations by writing and executing code, including code that involves sequential events.

In plain terms: students put step-by-step instructions in the right order to get a result.

C3.2 — read and alter existing code, including code that involves sequential events, and describe how changes to the code affect the outcomes.

In plain terms: students read a set of steps, change or reorder one, and explain what the change did.

You'll know it worked when

The child names the job for each set of steps and writes a sensible ordered plan for the leftover one.